

The following is a faithful transcription
of the handwritten original by the Servant
of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

1946, April 2

ST. MICHAEL'S CHURCH
225 JEROME STREET
BROOKLYN 7, N. Y.

April 2, 1946

Dear Fr. M. E. Joachim:

God bless you and yours.

Glad to hear of your continued health-improvement.
Deo gratias. Also of what I am sure you must have enjoyed, a few days visit to LaCross and again to old Prescott and St. Mary's "Bigrifer" I suppose. How wonderful the ways of the Dear Good God!

When we think of the blessings of the past -- since we went berrying and picking hops and nuts and digging jinsang, etc. . . . still further back, when the "old field" was all we had open and the prairie-chickens, etc used to stage a picture like that of the first Paradise in the morning sun as they shook the dew from the great oaks, up to the East.....!! You and I are all left now who can go back to our first Spring in old Trimbelle . . . Deo gratias!

I have never seen a picture -- in Bible-history or elsewhere so nearly like an erthly paradise as I remember that scenery to be -- with deer in twos, threes and more, stopping on the hill-side or vallies to gaze at what we might be doing. No doubt what heightened to the appreciation of those days was our innocence (from sin) -- and how the hawks themselves every fall were wont -- as we would play on the grass stoping at time to watch them -- to circle around and around again and again in their upward fight and right over our log-palace and plot of green. They seemed to me as they circled to the clouds to invite us to strive with them to get up to Heaven. They were surely an inspiration and I've often thought in later years that God in His goodness and wisdom very likely gave those simple birds a pleasure of some kind in giving us playing youngsters such an entertainment. . . .